MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準1級
リーディングトレーニング

第2回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜18	短文の語句空所補充
2	19〜24	長文の語句空所補充
3	25〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
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1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The emergency measures were intended to be temporary, yet they remained in force so long that they became ( ) in daily administration.

1 spontaneous **2** entrenched **3** fickle **4** benign

(2) Because the witness had a financial interest in the outcome, the judge treated his testimony with ( ).

1 euphoria **2** complacency **3** deference **4** circumspection

(3) Several smaller clinics decided to ( ) their purchasing power so they could negotiate lower prices for medical supplies.

1 amalgamate **2** squander **3** estrange **4** fabricate

(4) The auditor found a troubling ( ) between the inventory recorded in the ledger and the stock actually stored in the warehouse.

1 affinity **2** prerogative **3** discrepancy **4** threshold

(5) Far from calming investors, the executive's vague statement only ( ) speculation that the merger was in trouble.

1 alleviated **2** ratified **3** curtailed **4** fomented

(6) The new archival software is remarkably ( ), handling formats created decades ago alongside current files.

1 parochial **2** versatile **3** punitive **4** opaque

(7) Critics argued that the subsidy was ( ) because most recipients would have upgraded their heating systems anyway.

1 stringent **2** clandestine **3** superfluous **4** volatile

(8) Even minor delays at the port can have ( ) effects across factories that keep minimal parts in reserve.

1 ramifying **2** sedentary **3** trivial **4** benevolent

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(9) The board refused to (　　) the misconduct, insisting that seniority could not excuse a breach of safety rules.

1 instigate　**2** preempt　**3** condone　**4** repudiate

(10) Although the pamphlet promised a comprehensive guide, its treatment of tax exemptions was decidedly (　　).

1 exhaustive　**2** lucid　**3** meticulous　**4** cursory

(11) The coastal town faces a (　　) dilemma: seawalls protect homes from storms, yet they accelerate beach erosion.

1 transient　**2** perennial　**3** docile　**4** spurious

(12) To prevent conflicts of interest, committee members must (　　) themselves from votes involving former employers.

1 recuse　**2** exonerate　**3** bolster　**4** ingratiate

(13) Public enthusiasm for the festival began to (　　) once admission fees rose faster than household incomes.

1 proliferate　**2** culminate　**3** coalesce　**4** wane

(14) The treaty's wording was deliberately left (　　) so each government could claim success before its parliament.

1 unequivocal　**2** immutable　**3** ambiguous　**4** stringent

(15) A sudden freeze in credit forced the developer to (　　) plans for the second tower indefinitely.

1 shelve　**2** expedite　**3** embellish　**4** vindicate

(16) Rather than clarify the issue, the spokesperson's lengthy digression seemed designed to (　　) the core question.

1 illuminate　**2** obfuscate　**3** corroborate　**4** rectify

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(17) When the key supplier went bankrupt, the manufacturer had to (　　) emergency stocks held at regional depots.

1 brush up on　**2** fall back on　**3** do away with　**4** live up to

(18) What seemed a minor rule change eventually (　　) a broad overhaul of how municipal grants were audited.

1 phased out　**2** stemmed from　**3** backed out of　**4** gave rise to

2 長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

When Forecasts Shape What They Predict

Weather forecasts do not alter the path of a storm. Carrying an umbrella neither summons rain nor disperses clouds. Many institutional forecasts, however, operate in social settings where people react to the prediction itself. When a hospital predicts an unusually crowded weekend and schedules extra nurses, waiting times may stay moderate precisely because the warning prompted preparation. Judged naively against the final numbers, an effective warning can resemble an exaggerated alarm.

The opposite distortion is equally common. Suppose a regional water authority announces that reservoir levels are comfortable for the rest of the summer. Households relax their conservation habits, factories delay fixing minor leaks, and consumption rises enough to create the shortage that earlier seemed unlikely. In both cases, treating a forecast as a passive mirror ignores how announcements (19).

Evaluators therefore face a methodological trap if they compare predicted outcomes only with raw results. A transport agency that warns commuters about severe congestion around bridge repairs may persuade thousands of travelers to leave earlier or switch to rail. Traffic then flows smoothly, prompting critics to ask why disruptive notices were issued at all. (20), penalizing planners whenever predicted crises fail to materialize creates a perverse incentive to issue timid warnings or withhold protective action.

A sounder approach separates baseline projections from conditional scenarios. Agencies can state what is likely if current behavior continues alongside what is expected if recommended precautions are taken. Publishing both pathways does not eliminate uncertainty, yet it helps the public (21). Accountability improves when institutions are judged on the clarity of their assumptions rather than on whether a preventable problem actually occurred.

(19)

1 preserve identical habits across seasons
2 depend entirely on meteorological equipment
3 alter the behavior they aim to anticipate
4 remove the need for public communication

(20)

1 Indeed
2 Nevertheless
3 Otherwise
4 Meanwhile

(21)

1 ignore future maintenance schedules altogether
2 demand that all forecasts guarantee a single figure
3 prevent agencies from revising baseline data
4 distinguish a failed forecast from a successful intervention

Why Repair Manuals Disappear

Consumers who try to mend an appliance often discover that the hardest component to obtain is not a spare switch or gasket, but a clear diagram of how the casing opens. Manufacturers sometimes attribute restricted documentation to safety or intellectual property concerns. Those considerations are real where high-voltage parts or proprietary software are involved, yet the scarcity of repair manuals also reflects how product revenues are structured.

When margins on initial sales narrow, after-sales servicing and early replacement become vital profit streams. Independent repair shops compete directly with authorized service networks if both can diagnose faults quickly. Keeping diagnostic codes and disassembly sequences inside closed portals tilts routine repairs toward official channels. Even customers willing to pay for genuine parts may abandon a repair if (22).

Recent "right-to-repair" regulations attempt to rebalance this relationship by requiring firms to publish maintenance guides and sell common parts for a set period. Compliance on paper, however, does not guarantee practical usability. A manual released as thousands of unindexed pages or written in deliberately cryptic shorthand satisfies a narrow legal duty while deterring ordinary technicians. (23), regulators in several jurisdictions have begun specifying searchability, legibility, and reasonable pricing alongside mere availability.

Designing products and manuals for repairability can benefit manufacturers that take a longer view. Clear documentation reduces misdiagnosed returns, helps field technicians spot recurring defects early, and strengthens trust among institutional buyers managing hundreds of devices. Treating manuals as part of product quality encourages firms to (24) instead of viewing durability as a threat to future sales.

(22)

1 diagnosing the fault costs nearly as much effort as buying a new unit

2 official portals publish free diagrams immediately

3 independent technicians charge nothing for labor

4 manufacturers extend the warranty without conditions

(23)

1 Conversely

2 Accordingly

3 Incidentally

4 Nonetheless

(24)

1 restrict spare parts to single-use assemblies

2 conceal recurring defects from institutional buyers

3 compete through dependable longevity and service

4 replace all written guides with verbal briefings

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Counting Trees Is Not Counting Shade

Municipal climate plans increasingly advertise ambitious tree-planting targets. Announcing that fifty thousand saplings will enter the ground over five years sounds concrete, photogenic, and easy for voters to grasp. Yet urban foresters warn that headline planting counts often correlate poorly with how much cooling a city actually gains a decade later. Without attention to survival, placement, and mature canopy size, a campaign can meet its numerical pledge while leaving summer pavements nearly as hot as before.

Young trees planted in cramped sidewalk pits face compacted soil, road salt, reflected heat, and erratic watering. Studies of several metropolitan drives found that a substantial share of newly planted street trees died within four years, long before their crowns could cast meaningful shade. Because budgets typically reward capital planting projects more generously than routine arboricultural care, departments may replace dead saplings repeatedly rather than fund soil volume improvements or summer irrigation crews.

Geography compounds the problem. Planting targets are easiest to fulfill in parks, school grounds, or leafy suburbs where wide verges already exist and homeowners volunteer to water young stock. Dense commercial corridors and older tenement blocks—often the hottest neighborhoods during heat waves—require utility relocation, pavement cutting, and negotiation over loading zones. When agencies chase raw totals under tight deadlines, trees flow toward the simplest sites rather than the streets where heat stress is most acute.

Measuring canopy cover and surface temperature at regular intervals offers a better standard than tallying shovels in the ground. Some cities now weight tree budgets by heat-vulnerability maps and reserve multi-year maintenance funds before a single pit is dug. Fewer trees may be planted in the first season under such rules, yet a smaller cohort that survives to maturity over scorching bus stops delivers far greater public benefit than thousands of short-lived saplings on already shaded lawns.

Counting Trees Is Not Counting Shade — Questions

(25) What main weakness of municipal tree-planting targets does the author identify?

1 Tallies of planted saplings can obscure low survival rates and poor siting.

2 Voters generally oppose spending public money on street vegetation.

3 Mature trees raise surrounding pavement temperatures at night.

4 Foresters lack instruments to measure urban heat differences.

(26) According to the second paragraph, why do departments often keep replacing dead saplings instead of improving care?

1 Young trees cannot survive more than four years in any city climate.

2 Arborists are legally barred from altering sidewalk soil pits.

3 Funding structures favor initial planting projects over ongoing maintenance.

4 Homeowners refuse to allow irrigation trucks onto residential streets.

(27) What leads agencies to plant fewer trees in the hottest neighborhoods?

1 Heat waves make utility pipes unnecessary in commercial corridors.

2 Suburban parks prohibit volunteer watering programs.

3 Tenement residents prefer wider loading zones to shaded sidewalks.

4 Installing trees in dense districts involves costly physical and administrative hurdles.

The Hidden Cost of Microloans for Artisans

Small, short-term loans have long been promoted as a straightforward tool for lifting self-employed artisans out of poverty. When a weaver lacks cash to buy dyed yarn or a potter needs fuel for a kiln, access to modest credit appears to unlock immediate productivity. In many towns, microlending programs have indeed freed borrowers from informal moneylenders charging ruinous rates. Yet evaluations conducted over longer horizons suggest that credit design—especially repayment timing—shapes whether artisans merely stay afloat or build durable enterprises.

Conventional microloans often require weekly installments starting almost immediately after funds are disbursed. That schedule reduces default risk for lenders and instills predictable routines, which works reasonably well for street vendors whose goods turn over every afternoon. Craft production, however, rarely generates steady daily cash. Commissioning a loom attachment, seasoning timber, or fulfilling a wholesale order for a seasonal fair requires weeks of outlay before revenue arrives. Faced with rigid weekly dues, artisans frequently divert part of the loan to cover early installments or stick to quick, low-margin repairs rather than higher-value orders.

Group-liability rules can reinforce this caution. Where neighbors co-sign one another's loans, social pressure keeps repayment rates impressively high—a metric celebrated in donor reports. At the same time, peers who fear covering a neighbor's shortfall naturally discourage unfamiliar designs, new buyers, or equipment upgrades whose payoff is uncertain. High repayment statistics can therefore coexist with stagnant household incomes.

Recognizing these dynamics has led several development banks to test grace periods, seasonal schedules, and shared workshop leases. In controlled trials, delaying the first installment by two months raised investment in tools and bulk materials, lifted workshop profits over two years, and slightly increased defaults—a trade-off lenders could absorb through modest reserve funds. Credit helps artisans grow not when rules maximize administrative convenience, but when financing matches the rhythm of production.

The Hidden Cost of Microloans for Artisans — Questions

(28) Why do standard weekly repayment schedules suit street vendors better than artisans?

1 Street vendors receive government subsidies for every installment.

2 Vendors earn cash daily, whereas craft orders require longer upfront production cycles.

3 Artisans are prohibited from purchasing raw materials in small quantities.

4 Lenders waive interest charges for food and retail stalls.

(29) How can artisans react when weekly repayments begin immediately?

1 They routinely abandon craftwork to become loan officers.

2 They form wholesale cooperatives that eliminate seasonal fairs.

3 They may hold back cash for early dues and avoid ambitious, higher-margin work.

4 They invest the entire loan in experimental machinery.

(30) What unintended effect of group-liability rules is discussed in the third paragraph?

1 They cause repayment rates to collapse in rural districts.

2 Peer pressure against risk can deter innovation even while repayment stays high.

3 They force donor agencies to stop publishing statistical reports.

4 They legally prevent neighbors from sharing workshop tools.

(31) What did trials of two-month grace periods demonstrate?

1 Defaults disappeared completely without changing borrower profits.

2 Seasonal schedules worked only when paired with informal moneylenders.

3 Delaying installments benefited lenders financially while hurting workshops.

4 Artisans invested more in productive assets and earned higher profits despite a small rise in defaults.